

SUMMARY

I turn complex product capabilities into reasons customers adopt, pay, and stay.

I spent seven years in product marketing at Adobe, then seven years leading product and product marketing together, the last three as Director of Product Management. Leading product changed how I approach product marketing: I know how to challenge the roadmap, make the investment case, understand the technical tradeoffs, and turn what gets built into a proposition the market understands.

I do my best work when product decisions, customer evidence, positioning, and adoption have to be solved together. I've positioned complex platforms, led launches that required changes to both the product and the go-to-market, used customer behavior to change product direction, and now use AI and coding tools as part of how I research, prototype, and ship.

PROTOTYPE BUILT FOR NASH

nicoleminoza.com/working-theory ↗

Working Theory. How I approach ambiguous product, positioning, and GTM decisions.

HIGHLIGHTS

- **Repositioned Typekit from a standalone service into a core Creative Cloud benefit.** Chose the Adobe Fonts name after Adobe removed activation limits, won brand approval, directed the site build, and led the relaunch across product, PR, partners, sales, and legacy customers. Monthly active users grew 40% in year one with no foundry or licensing-partner losses.
- **Turned font discovery into a paid-conversion opportunity.** Reframed recommendations from a quality feature into a revenue opportunity, won funding for ML-powered recommendations, and secured Adobe Express as the first launch partner. Free-to-paid conversion rose from 0.5% to 1.42%.
- **Proved Adobe Fonts was a retention driver.** A causal analysis of 3.25M Creative Cloud subscribers showed adopters churned 42% less the following month. The analysis was repeated annually and became part of the executive case for continued investment.
- **Made the case for a shared text platform across Adobe products.** Wrote the narrative that helped move Adobe applications from separate text engines onto shared infrastructure. The platform now serves 15M monthly users and delivers 40x faster core typographic actions on the web.
- **Set Adobe Fonts' generative AI strategy.** Defined how typography would evolve for generative AI, shipped generative text editing in Firefly Boards, and secured Photoshop and Express commitments for broader adoption.

EXPERIENCE

Independent · Product, Positioning & AI

SEATTLE, WA · MAR 2026 – PRESENT

Build AI products, conduct original research, and advise companies on positioning and go-to-market.

- **Designed and ran an original LLM evaluation study** across 1,890 API calls and three model families, building the harness and metrics layer and tracing every published finding back to source responses.
- **Use coding agents to ship production websites and product experiences from brief through QA**, turning a brief into a working product, then reviewing and refining the output through QA.
- **Built House Style**, a library of 40+ opinionated AI prompts for marketing, brand, and product leaders, in React with Claude Code.
- **Advise founder-led businesses on positioning and go-to-market**, helping founders decide what they should promise, what proves it, and how the website should make the case.

Adobe

JUL 2002 – FEB 2026

Director, Product Management

Seattle, WA · Jun 2023 – Feb 2026

First product director for Adobe's fonts and typography organization. Led 6 product managers and set direction for a 75-person organization across product, design, and engineering.

- **Shifted portfolio investment toward AI.** Moved AI from 10% to 50% of annual portfolio investment across two planning cycles, decided where generative typography belonged in the roadmap, and used the first Firefly Boards release as proof to secure Photoshop and Express commitments for broader adoption.

Director, Product Management — CONTINUED

- **Used missing-font failures to justify Adobe’s largest font-library expansion in five years.** Built the case for the Monotype and Microsoft expansion from observed user drop-off and missing-font behavior. The launch added 900 new fonts, reached 1.2M adopters within weeks, eliminated 21.1M missing-font failure events, and cut failed searches 91%.
- **Grew Adobe Fonts to 12M+ monthly users while increasing website traffic 35% year over year.** Ran the website as an acquisition funnel as the service expanded across Creative Cloud.
- **Promoted three Senior Product Managers to Principal Product Manager** as they took on broader scope and influence across the organization.

Group Manager, Product & Product Marketing Seattle, WA · Mar 2019 – Jun 2023

Expanded my role to lead both product strategy and product marketing, leading a team of 8 across product, product marketing, community, and content. Owned the business strategy and presented it annually to the senior vice president.

- **Made the case for moving Adobe applications onto a shared text platform.** Persuaded product teams application by application by tying better performance, interoperability, and international typography support to each team’s roadmap.
- **Changed foundry payments from activation-based to usage-based.** Won executive approval for a usage-based royalty model and led the product changes, partner conversations, and measurement required to put it into practice, saving \$1M in the first two quarters while usage continued to grow.
- **Ran a standing forum for product owners across 12 Adobe applications to resolve roadmap conflicts** and platform dependencies before escalation.
- **Moved a Senior Product Marketing Manager into Creative Cloud marketing** so Adobe Fonts could use the larger organization’s launch and acquisition channels.

Group Product Marketing Manager Seattle, WA · Mar 2016 – Mar 2019

Led positioning and go-to-market as the team grew to 8 and transformed Typekit into Adobe Fonts.

- **Led the Adobe Fonts relaunch** across customer messaging, partner communications, PR, Adobe.com, product changes, sales materials, and legacy customers.
- **Expanded the catalog from roughly 3,000 to 36,000 fonts** and grew the foundry network as Adobe Fonts became a core Creative Cloud benefit.
- **Created Adobe’s Global Emoji Trend Reports.** Directed research with 7,000 respondents across 7 countries in 2021 and 5,000 U.S. respondents across 6 markets in 2022; scoped the research and led PR.
- **Moved members of the support team into product, community, and content roles** including later promotions to Senior Product Manager, Associate Product Manager, and Senior Content Producer.

Senior Product Marketing Manager San Jose, CA · Jan 2012 – Mar 2016

Sole senior marketer for fonts and typography after the Typekit acquisition, with a \$1M annual budget and ownership of launches, partnerships, community, and press.

- **Led positioning, launch, and press for Source Han Sans**, Adobe’s first open-source typeface spanning Chinese, Japanese, and Korean. Made the naming case for “Source,” served as spokesperson, and earned coverage in The Next Web and CNET.
- **Led Adobe Originals’ 25th Anniversary campaign** anchored by the open-source release of Source Serif.

Quality Engineer → Senior Program Manager San Jose, CA · Jul 2002 – Jan 2012

A decade in quality engineering and technical program management, coordinating releases with Photoshop, Illustrator, InDesign, and Acrobat teams.

EDUCATION & LEADERSHIP DEVELOPMENT

MBA, Marketing	Santa Clara University
BA, Political Science	University of California, Los Angeles
AI-Driven Leadership	Stanford Online
Strategic Data Storytelling	University of Chicago
Executive Leadership Program	McKinsey & Company